

Khibra

Business Requirements Document (Partial): Overview, Objectives, Stakeholders, Glossary, Scope, Epics & User Stories

1. Document Overview

Field	Detail
Document Title	Business Requirements Document — Khibra (Saudi Arabia)
Product/Platform Name	TBD — working name: “Khibra”
Version	0.1 (Draft)
Date	September 9, 2026
Author/Owner	[Placeholder — Business Analyst Name]
Status	Draft for stakeholder review
Document Purpose	This document defines the business objectives, stakeholder landscape, terminology, scope boundaries, and high-level requirements (Epics and User Stories) for a curated, managed on-demand expert marketplace serving the Saudi market. It is intended as a foundational reference for Product, UI/UX, Engineering, and Management to align on what is being built and why, ahead of detailed functional specification.
Product Overview	A curated marketplace platform that connects organizations (clients) in Saudi Arabia with verified, senior-level independent experts for consulting, advisory, fractional executive, mentoring, and project-based engagements. The platform is a managed marketplace (not an open freelancer directory): experts are vetted and curated, and engagements are actively matched/supported rather than self-served end-to-end by algorithm alone.

Document History Log

Version	Date	Author	Change Description
0.1	Sep 9, 2026	[Placeholder]	Initial draft — Overview, Objectives, Stakeholders, Glossary, Scope, Epics, User Stories

2. Business Objective

Business Problem Saudi organizations undergoing transformation (Vision 2030-driven growth, giga-projects, privatization, localization) frequently need short-term access to deep, senior-level expertise — for advisory, interim leadership, or specific project execution — without the cost, time, or commitment of a permanent hire. Existing options are limited: traditional consulting firms are expensive and slow to mobilize; open freelance platforms lack the seniority, vetting, and trust required for high-stakes engagements; and informal referral networks are inconsistent and don’t scale.

At the same time, Saudi Arabia has a growing pool of highly experienced, recently retired senior professionals — executives, technical specialists, and industry leaders — whose deep expertise is currently underutilized after they leave full-time employment.

Proposed Solution A curated, managed marketplace that:

- Sources and rigorously vets senior experts, with retired professionals as the primary supply segment, supplemented selectively by non-retired senior professionals to fill capability or coverage gaps.
- Matches client organizations to the right expert(s) for advisory, fractional executive, mentoring, or project-based engagements.

- Manages the engagement lifecycle (proposal, contracting, delivery, payment) to reduce friction and risk for both sides.
- Positions itself around expertise, credibility, flexibility, and business outcomes — never around age or retirement status — even though retired professionals are the core supply strategy.

Business Objectives

#	Objective
BO1	Build a trusted, curated supply pool of senior Saudi (and Saudi-market-relevant) experts, primarily sourced from recently retired senior professionals.
BO2	Provide client organizations a faster, lower-risk, more flexible alternative to traditional consulting engagements and permanent senior hires.
BO3	Establish the platform as a credible, premium brand for senior expertise — not perceived as a “gig work” or “retiree” platform.
BO4	Create a repeatable, manageable engagement lifecycle (request → match → contract → delivery → payment → review) that reduces administrative burden on both clients and experts.
BO5	Generate sustainable platform revenue (e.g., placement fee, commission, or subscription — OPEN ITEM: monetization model not yet defined).
BO6	Support Saudization / knowledge-transfer narratives by facilitating structured mentoring and capability transfer from senior experts to client teams.
BO7	Maintain a controlled, quality-gated non-retired expert segment strictly for capability/supply-gap coverage, without diluting the platform’s core positioning.

Success Criteria (OPEN ITEM — targets require business confirmation; illustrative categories below)

- Number of vetted, active experts onboarded within X months.
- Number of client organizations onboarded and repeat-engagement rate.
- Average time from client request to expert match (target TBD).
- Client and expert satisfaction / NPS scores.
- Revenue / take-rate against defined monetization model.
- Ratio of retired vs. non-retired experts on the platform, monitored against a defined cap (OPEN ITEM: the cap or threshold for “controlled number” of non-retired experts is not yet defined).

Target Users — Client Organizations: private-sector companies, giga-project entities, government-linked organizations, SMEs, and family businesses needing senior expertise on demand. Experts: primarily retired senior professionals (executives, subject-matter experts, former regulators, technical leaders); secondarily, a controlled pool of non-retired senior professionals.

Assumptions (to be validated)

- There is sufficient supply of retired senior professionals in Saudi Arabia willing and able to take on part-time/advisory work.
- Client organizations are willing to engage experts through a managed marketplace rather than direct hire or traditional consulting firms.
- Regulatory framework permits retired professionals to consult/advise without restriction (OPEN ITEM: pension, government-employment, or non-compete restrictions on retired public/private sector employees need legal confirmation).

Dependencies

- Legal/compliance review of contracting model (is the platform an agent, marketplace, or employer-of-record for engagements?) — OPEN ITEM.

- Payment/escrow mechanism and applicable financial regulations — OPEN ITEM.
- Verification/KYC approach for expert credentials — OPEN ITEM (see Section 5, Out of Scope note).

3. Stakeholders

Role	Description	Primary Interest
Client Organization — Requester	Individual at a client company who submits an engagement need (e.g., HR lead, project sponsor, department head).	Fast, credible match to the right expert.
Client Organization — Approver/Decision-Maker	Senior stakeholder at the client who approves expert selection, contract terms, and budget.	Risk mitigation, ROI, credibility of expert.
Client Organization — Finance/Procurement	Handles invoicing, payment processing, vendor onboarding on the client side.	Compliant, predictable billing and contracting.
Expert (Retired Senior Professional)	Core supply segment; recently retired executives/specialists offering advisory, fractional, or project-based services.	Flexible, dignified, well-matched engagements; fair compensation; credibility-first positioning.
Expert (Non-Retired Senior Professional)	Controlled secondary supply segment brought in for specific capability/coverage gaps.	Selective, high-value engagements without full-time commitment.
Platform Curation/Vetting Team	Internal team responsible for sourcing, vetting, and onboarding experts; maintaining quality bar.	Expert quality, credibility of supply pool.
Platform Matching/Account Team	Internal team (or algorithm + human hybrid) that matches client requests to experts and manages the relationship.	Successful matches, client and expert satisfaction.
Platform Operations/Support	Handles day-to-day issue resolution, contract administration, dispute handling.	Smooth engagement lifecycle, low friction.
Platform Finance/Payments Team	Manages invoicing, payouts to experts, commission/fee collection.	Accurate, timely, compliant financial flows.
Platform Administrator	Manages platform configuration, roles, policies, categories, approval workflows.	Governance, configurability, control.
Executive/Management Sponsor	Owns the business case and strategic direction of the platform.	Growth, brand positioning, sustainable revenue.
Legal/Compliance	Ensures contracting model, data handling, and payments meet Saudi regulatory requirements.	Regulatory compliance, risk mitigation.
Marketing/Brand Team	Owns external positioning — ensuring messaging emphasizes expertise/credibility, not age/retirement.	Brand perception and positioning integrity.
System	The platform itself, performing automated actions (matching suggestions, notifications, status transitions, etc.).	Reliable, auditable automated behavior.

4. Glossary

Term	Definition
Expert	A vetted, curated senior professional (retired or non-retired) available for engagement through the platform.
Retired Expert	An expert who has formally retired from full-time employment; the platform's primary supply segment.
Active/Non-Retired Expert	A currently employed or otherwise professionally active senior expert admitted selectively to fill capability gaps.
Client Organization	A company or entity that engages experts through the platform.
Engagement	A defined work arrangement between a client and one or more experts, of a specific type (advisory, fractional, mentoring, project-based).
Advisory Engagement	A lower-intensity, typically ongoing engagement where an expert provides strategic guidance.
Fractional Executive Engagement	A part-time, senior leadership role (e.g., fractional CFO) filled by an expert on a recurring but less-than-full-time basis.
Mentoring Engagement	An engagement focused on developing a client's internal talent through structured knowledge transfer.
Project-Based Engagement	A defined-scope, defined-duration engagement to deliver a specific outcome or deliverable.
Curation	The internal process of sourcing, vetting, and approving experts before they are made visible/available on the platform.
Matching	The process (manual, algorithmic, or hybrid) of connecting a client's request with one or more suitable experts.
Engagement Brief	The client's structured statement of need used to initiate the matching process.
Proposal	An expert's (or the platform's, on the expert's behalf) response to an engagement brief, including scope, approach, and terms.
Contract	The formal agreement governing an engagement, including scope, duration, and commercial terms.
Take Rate / Commission	The fee the platform retains from an engagement's value (OPEN ITEM: model not yet defined).
Vetting	The verification and quality-assessment process applied to prospective experts (credentials, experience, references).
Knowledge Transfer	The intentional transmission of an expert's know-how to client staff during an engagement.
Capability Gap	An area where the retired-expert pool cannot adequately meet client demand, justifying admission of a non-retired expert.
Supply Pool	The overall set of onboarded, active experts available for matching.

5. Scope

In Scope

- Expert onboarding, profile creation, and curated vetting workflow (primary focus on retired senior professionals; controlled pathway for non-retired experts).
- Client organization onboarding and engagement request submission (Engagement Brief).
- Matching process between client requests and experts (manual/hybrid to start; OPEN ITEM: degree of algorithmic automation).
- Engagement types: advisory, fractional executive, mentoring, and project-based.
- Proposal, negotiation, and contracting workflow for an engagement.
- Engagement lifecycle management (active engagement tracking, milestones/deliverables where applicable).
- Ratings/feedback between clients and experts post-engagement.
- Basic reporting for platform operations (expert pool composition, engagement volume, satisfaction).
- Role-based access for Client, Expert, Curation/Ops, and Admin user types.
- Positioning and content presentation that emphasizes expertise, credibility, and outcomes (not age/retirement status) — a product/UX requirement, not just a marketing one.

Out of Scope (for this phase — candidates for Future Scope)

- Full payment gateway / escrow implementation details (to be scoped separately with Finance/Legal).
- Government/regulatory integrations (e.g., Nafath, ZATCA e-invoicing) — OPEN ITEM on whether/when required.
- Open, self-serve freelancer marketplace features (unmanaged, non-curated listing) — explicitly excluded, as the product is a managed/curated model, not an open marketplace.
- International (non-Saudi) client or expert onboarding — OPEN ITEM whether GCC expansion is a near-term consideration.
- Full learning/training-content marketplace (beyond mentoring engagements tied to a specific client need).

Future Scope / Potential Enhancements

- Algorithmic/AI-assisted matching at scale.
- Expert-side subscription or membership tiers.
- Structured fractional-executive “bench” programs for recurring client demand.
- Regional (GCC) expansion.
- Integration with government verification systems for credential checks.

Key Constraints

- Positioning constraint: all client-facing content, matching rationale, and expert presentation must avoid referencing age or retirement status as a value proposition — this affects profile design, search/filter design, and marketing copy.
- Non-retired experts must be admitted only against a defined, controlled process tied to demonstrated capability gaps (OPEN ITEM: governance rule/threshold not yet defined).

- Regulatory and tax treatment of independent expert engagements in Saudi Arabia is not yet confirmed — affects contracting and payment design.

6. Epics

Epic ID	Epic Name	Description
EP01	Expert Onboarding & Curation	Sourcing, application, vetting, and approval of experts (retired-primary, non-retired-controlled) onto the platform.
EP02	Expert Profile & Availability Management	Experts build and maintain profiles, expertise areas, engagement preferences, and availability.
EP03	Client Onboarding & Organization Management	Client organizations register, manage users (requester/approver/finance), and maintain company profiles.
EP04	Engagement Request & Briefing	Clients define and submit an engagement need (type, scope, expertise required, duration, budget).
EP05	Matching & Expert Discovery	Connecting client briefs to suitable experts via search, curated shortlist, and/or algorithmic suggestions.
EP06	Proposal, Negotiation & Contracting	Formalizing engagement terms between client and expert(s), including scope, duration, and commercial terms.
EP07	Engagement Delivery & Tracking	Managing an active engagement — milestones, communication, deliverables, status.
EP08	Payments, Invoicing & Commission	Handling client billing, expert payout, and platform commission/fee capture.
EP09	Ratings, Feedback & Reputation	Post-engagement feedback from both client and expert, feeding expert reputation and platform quality control.
EP10	Platform Administration & Configuration	Admin control over categories, approval workflows, fee structures, non-retired-expert quotas, and content rules.
EP11	Reporting & Business Intelligence	Operational, financial, and quality reporting for platform management.
EP12	Trust, Verification & Compliance	Credential verification, dispute handling, and regulatory compliance mechanisms.
EP13	Brand-Safe Positioning & Content Governance	Ensuring all user-facing surfaces (profiles, search, matching rationale, marketing) reflect expertise/credibility framing rather than age/retirement framing.

7. User Stories

Organized by Epic. Format: US# | As a [role], I want to [action], so that [value]. | Related Epic

EP01 — Expert Onboarding & Curation

US#	User Story	Epic
US001	As a prospective retired expert, I want to apply to join the platform with my professional background, so that I can be considered for curated engagements.	EP01
US002	As a prospective non-retired expert, I want to apply through a distinct pathway, so that my application is evaluated against capability-gap criteria rather than general open supply.	EP01
US003	As a curation team member, I want to review an expert application against defined vetting criteria (experience, seniority, references), so that only credible experts are approved.	EP01
US004	As a curation team member, I want to flag whether a non-retired applicant fills a specific capability gap, so that the platform's controlled-quota rule can be enforced.	EP01
US005	As a curation team member, I want to reject or return an application for correction with clear reasons, so that applicants understand next steps.	EP01
US006	As an admin, I want to configure the vetting criteria and required documentation per expert category, so that curation standards can evolve without code changes.	EP01

EP02 — Expert Profile & Availability Management

US#	User Story	Epic
US007	As an expert, I want to build a profile highlighting my expertise, industry experience, and achievements, so that clients can assess my fit for engagements.	EP02
US008	As an expert, I want my profile to present my seniority and track record without surfacing my age or retirement status, so that I am evaluated on expertise, consistent with platform positioning.	EP02
US009	As an expert, I want to set my availability (hours/days/engagement types I accept), so that I am only matched to suitable opportunities.	EP02
US010	As an expert, I want to update my profile and availability at any time, so that my presented information stays accurate.	EP02
US011	As an expert, I want to pause my profile visibility temporarily, so that I am not matched while unavailable.	EP02

EP03 — Client Onboarding & Organization Management

US#	User Story	Epic
US012	As a client organization admin, I want to register my organization on the platform, so that my company can begin submitting engagement requests.	EP03
US013	As a client organization admin, I want to add and manage users with different roles (requester, approver, finance), so that engagement workflows match our internal approval process.	EP03
US014	As a client requester, I want to view my organization's engagement history, so that I can reference past experts and outcomes.	EP03

EP04 — Engagement Request & Briefing

US#	User Story	Epic
US015	As a client requester, I want to submit an engagement brief specifying type (advisory/fractional/mentoring/project-based), required expertise, duration, and budget, so that the platform can identify suitable experts.	EP04
US016	As a client requester, I want to save a brief as a draft before submitting, so that I can complete it over multiple sessions.	EP04
US017	As a client approver, I want to review and approve an engagement brief before it is sent for matching, so that requests align with organizational budget and priorities.	EP04
US018	As a client requester, I want to edit or withdraw a submitted brief before matching is finalized, so that I can adjust to changing needs.	EP04

EP05 — Matching & Expert Discovery

US#	User Story	Epic
US019	As a matching/account team member, I want to view suggested experts against a submitted brief, so that I can curate a shortlist for the client.	EP05
US020	As a client requester, I want to receive a curated shortlist of experts with relevant profiles, so that I can select who to engage.	EP05
US021	As a client requester, I want to filter or search experts by expertise area, industry, and engagement type (not by age/retirement status), so that filtering aligns with the platform's credibility-first positioning.	EP05
US022	As a client requester, I want to request an introductory call with a shortlisted expert, so that I can assess fit before committing.	EP05
US023	As an expert, I want to be notified when I am shortlisted for an opportunity, so that I can review and respond.	EP05
US024	As an expert, I want to decline an opportunity that doesn't fit my availability or interest, so that I don't block the client's process.	EP05

EP06 — Proposal, Negotiation & Contracting

US#	User Story	Epic
US025	As an expert, I want to submit a proposal (scope, approach, timeline, rate) for a shortlisted engagement, so that the client can evaluate and confirm terms.	EP06
US026	As a client approver, I want to review and accept, reject, or request changes to a proposal, so that final terms meet organizational requirements.	EP06
US027	As a client approver, I want to negotiate commercial terms with an expert through the platform, so that agreement is reached before contract execution.	EP06
US028	As the system, I want to generate a contract document from agreed terms, so that both parties have a consistent, auditable record.	EP06
US029	As a client approver and expert, I want to digitally accept/sign the contract, so that the engagement can formally begin.	EP06

EP07 — Engagement Delivery & Tracking

US#	User Story	Epic
US030	As an expert, I want to log progress or update engagement status, so that the client and platform have visibility into delivery.	EP07

US#	User Story	Epic
US031	As a client requester, I want to view the current status of an active engagement, so that I can track progress against expectations.	EP07
US032	As a client requester or expert, I want to communicate within the platform regarding the engagement, so that discussion is documented in context.	EP07
US033	As a client approver, I want to confirm completion of a milestone or deliverable, so that payment can be triggered per contract terms.	EP07
US034	As an operations/support team member, I want to be notified of stalled or at-risk engagements, so that I can intervene proactively.	EP07
US035	As a client requester or expert, I want to request early termination or extension of an engagement, so that changes in circumstance can be accommodated.	EP07

EP08 — Payments, Invoicing & Commission

US#	User Story	Epic
US036	As the system, I want to generate an invoice to the client upon a billable milestone, so that payment can be collected per agreed terms.	EP08
US037	As a client finance user, I want to view and pay outstanding invoices, so that engagements remain in good standing.	EP08
US038	As the system, I want to calculate and deduct platform commission from the engagement value, so that platform revenue is captured accurately. (OPEN ITEM: commission model not yet defined.)	EP08
US039	As an expert, I want to receive payout for completed and approved work, so that I am compensated in a timely manner.	EP08
US040	As a platform finance team member, I want to view a reconciliation report of invoices, payouts, and commissions, so that I can ensure financial accuracy.	EP08

EP09 — Ratings, Feedback & Reputation

US#	User Story	Epic
US041	As a client requester, I want to rate and review an expert after engagement completion, so that future clients benefit from quality signals.	EP09
US042	As an expert, I want to rate and provide feedback on a client engagement, so that the platform can maintain quality on both sides.	EP09
US043	As a curation team member, I want to review low ratings or flagged feedback, so that I can take corrective action on expert or client accounts.	EP09

EP10 — Platform Administration & Configuration

US#	User Story	Epic
US044	As an admin, I want to configure expertise categories and engagement types, so that the taxonomy can evolve with market needs.	EP10
US045	As an admin, I want to configure the allowed proportion or threshold of non-retired experts in the active pool, so that the retired-first supply strategy is enforced. (OPEN ITEM: exact threshold/rule.)	EP10
US046	As an admin, I want to configure commission/fee rules, so that monetization terms can be adjusted without code changes.	EP10
US047	As an admin, I want to manage user roles and permissions across client, expert, and internal teams, so that access is properly controlled.	EP10

EP11 — Reporting & Business Intelligence

US#	User Story	Epic
US048	As management, I want a dashboard of expert pool composition (retired vs. non-retired, by expertise area), so that I can monitor supply strategy alignment.	EP11
US049	As management, I want a dashboard of engagement volume, value, and status, so that I can track platform performance against objectives.	EP11
US050	As management, I want visibility into client and expert satisfaction trends, so that I can identify quality issues early.	EP11

EP12 — Trust, Verification & Compliance

US#	User Story	Epic
US051	As a curation team member, I want to verify an expert's claimed credentials and professional history, so that platform trust is maintained. (OPEN ITEM: verification method/provider not yet defined.)	EP12
US052	As a support/operations team member, I want to log and manage disputes between clients and experts, so that issues are resolved consistently.	EP12
US053	As legal/compliance, I want engagement contracts to reflect applicable Saudi regulatory requirements, so that the platform and its users are compliant. (OPEN ITEM: specific regulatory framework.)	EP12

EP13 — Brand-Safe Positioning & Content Governance

US#	User Story	Epic
US054	As a marketing/content owner, I want profile templates and search/filter fields to exclude age or retirement-status attributes from client-facing views, so that platform positioning stays outcome- and credibility-focused.	EP13
US055	As an admin, I want to review and approve all client-facing copy templates (matching rationale, notifications, marketing content), so that messaging consistently emphasizes expertise and outcomes over demographic framing.	EP13

Open Items Summary (Requiring Business Clarification)

1. Platform monetization model (commission %, subscription, or hybrid) — affects EP08, US038, US046.
2. Governance rule/threshold for the “controlled number” of non-retired experts — affects EP01, EP10, US004, US045.
3. Legal/regulatory treatment of retired professionals consulting (pension, non-compete, government restrictions).
4. Expert credential verification method/provider (manual reference checks vs. third-party verification service).
5. Degree of algorithmic automation in matching (EP05) vs. fully human-curated shortlisting.
6. Payment/escrow mechanism and applicable financial regulations.
7. Whether government integrations (Nafath, ZATCA e-invoicing) are required in this phase.
8. Whether GCC/regional expansion is in near-term scope.

This document covers Sections 1–7 (Overview, Business Objective, Stakeholders, Glossary, Scope, Epics, User Stories) only, per current request. Detailed functional requirements, business rules, status models, use cases, validation rules, and other BRD sections from the full template are not yet developed and can be produced as a follow-on deliverable.